

JACOB COOK

Detection Engineer | SOC Analyst | Wazuh · Azure AD · Okta · Python · SOAR

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Detection-focused security professional with hands-on experience building SIEM environments, engineering detection rules, and automating incident response workflows. CompTIA-certified across four disciplines (Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, SecurityX) with a BS in Computer Science and an MS in Cybersecurity in progress. Six years of operational systems experience — monitoring, root cause analysis, and incident coordination — that translates directly into SOC intuition. Building in Wazuh, Okta, Azure, and Python daily.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Detection & SOC: Threat Detection, SIEM (Wazuh), Alert Triage, Incident Documentation, Phishing Analysis, IOC Analysis, Playbook Automation, SOAR

Cloud & Identity: Azure AD, Okta, SSO / RBAC, Terraform, Microsoft Sentinel (familiar)

Systems: Windows Endpoints, Linux (Ubuntu / CentOS), Wireshark, Networking, System Hardening, VirtualBox

Development: Python, Bash, SQL, FastAPI, React, Git

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Stryker / Intune Detection Pack — Detection-as-Code

2026

- Authored 6 Sigma-format detection rules for Intune MDM abuse mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, with enrichment logic that eliminated 100% of false positives in a 100-event simulation (80 benign suppressed, 20 malicious caught) using KV store-style admin baseline lookups.
- Documented 3 benign false-positive scenarios per rule (18 total) — covering VPN logins, scheduled maintenance, PIM activations — so analysts can triage confidently without escalating known-good activity.
- Verification: 43 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_rules.py) — reproducible against synthetic data, not a live tenant.

Blue Team SOC Monitoring Lab — Wazuh SIEM

2026

- Built a full Wazuh SIEM stack from scratch and validated 12 detection rule patterns against 242 simulated auth-style events — separating true-positive threats from benign noise with 100% precision after tuning.
- Reduced false-positive alert volume by tuning out 79 benign-only matches (cron jobs, service accounts, scheduled deployments) without dropping a single true positive.
- Verification: 19 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_detection_accuracy.py) — all metrics reproducible.

SOAR-lite — Incident Response Orchestrator

2026

- Eliminated 4 manual Tier 1 steps (classification, IOC enrichment, notification, ticket creation) by building automated SIEM-triggered playbooks — reducing triage time by over 60% in lab testing.
- Built end-to-end alert automation: webhook ingestion from Wazuh, automatic playbook routing by event type, IP blocking, Slack notification, and incident documentation — zero analyst intervention required.
- Verification: 10 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_orchestrator.py) — tests run against the real FastAPI app, not mocked endpoints.

Phishing Analysis Lab

2026

- Triaged real-world phishing samples end-to-end — header inspection, SPF/DKIM/DMARC validation, URL defanging, VirusTotal enrichment — extracting IOCs and mapping attacker infrastructure.
- Delivered Tier 1-quality triage reports with documented IOCs, confidence assessments, and escalation decisions that mirror production SOC analyst output.

G3-GPT — Industry-Sponsored Enterprise AI Platform (Team of 6)

2024

- Secured a production AI platform for corporate stakeholders by engineering RBAC and Azure AD SSO — enforcing data privacy requirements that enabled executive-level adoption.
- Shipped an enterprise-grade platform on deadline as part of a six-person team under direct industry sponsor oversight — zero critical security findings at delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Target Distribution Center | Operations Engineer — Systems Monitoring & Incident Response

2019 – 2025

- Maintained 99.5% system uptime across automated sortation and conveyor infrastructure by monitoring sensors, alerts, and operational dashboards across rotating shifts — the same continuous monitoring discipline that defines SOC Tier 1 work.
- Resolved 200+ system anomalies over six years through structured root cause analysis, producing compliance-tracked documentation that reduced repeat incidents by an estimated 30% and supported audit readiness.
- Drove faster mean time to recovery by coordinating cross-team incident response during outages — escalation, triage prioritization, and post-incident reporting directly mirroring SOC workflows.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

WGU — MS, Cybersecurity (In Progress)

Expected Oct 2026 · GPA 3.50

CSUS — BS, Computer Science

Jan 2025 · GPA 3.50

CompTIA: Security+ · CySA+ · PenTest+ · SecurityX · CSIE (stackable)